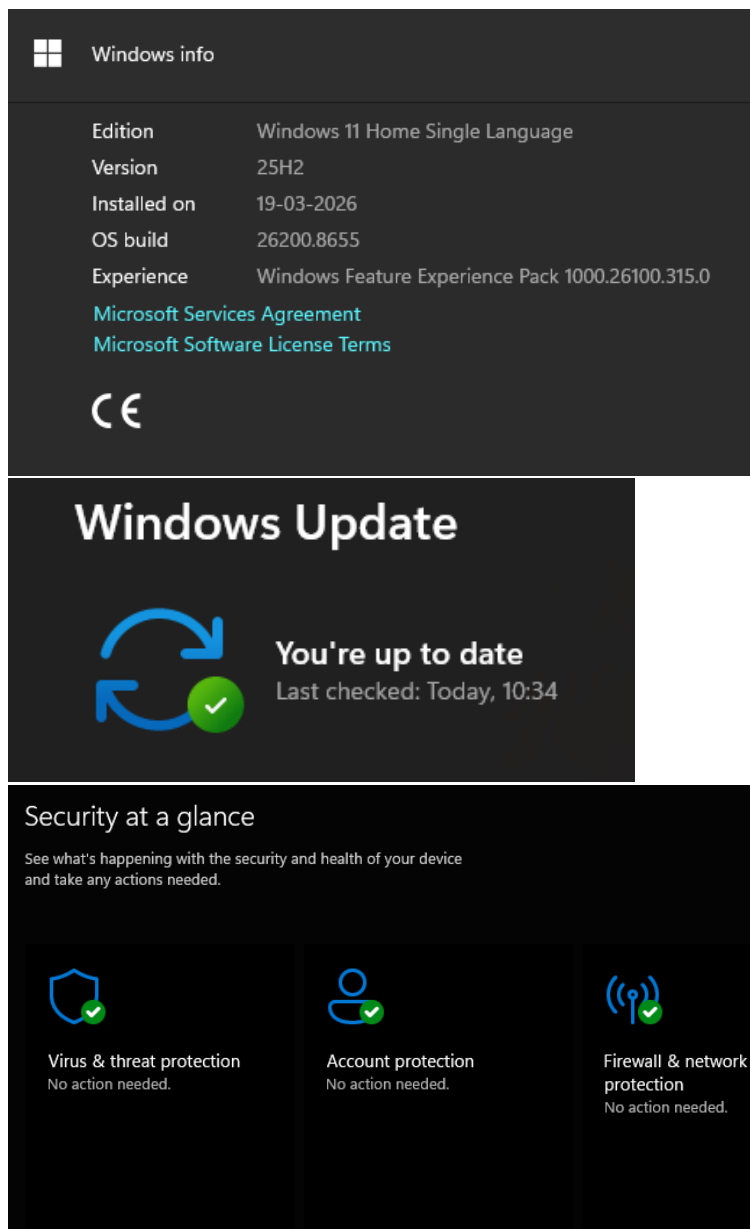


Cyber Security Task 01: Personal Security Audit & Cyber Awareness Assessment

Part A: Device Security Assessment

- **Operating System:** Windows
- **OS Version:** Windows 11 Home Single Language 25H2
- **Is the system updated?** Yes
- **Antivirus Installed? (Yes/No)** No
- **Firewall Enabled? (Yes/No)** Yes



Part B: Password Security Review

Answer the following:

- **What makes a strong password?**

A strong password is long, unique, and includes a mix of uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and special characters. Avoid using personal information or common words.

- **Why should passwords be unique?**

Passwords should be unique so that if one account is hacked, your other accounts stay safe. Using different passwords for each account improves security and protects your personal information.

- **What is Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)?**

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) is a security method that requires two or more verification steps, such as a password and a code sent to a phone. It improves security by making it harder for unauthorized users to access an account, even if they know the password.

- **What are the risks of password reuse?**

The main risk of password reuse is that if one account is hacked, attackers can use the same password to access other accounts. Using unique passwords for each account helps protect personal information and improves overall security.

- **Create a password policy containing at least 5 best practices.**

1. Use strong passwords that contain a mix of uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and special characters.
2. Make passwords at least 12 characters long to increase security.
3. Use a unique password for each account.
4. Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) whenever possible.
5. Avoid using personal information such as names, birthdays, or phone numbers in passwords.

Part C: Online Account Security Check

- **MFA Enabled? (Yes/No):** YES

- **Strong Password? (Yes/No):** YES
- **Recovery Email Configured? (Yes/No) :** YES

Account	MFA Enabled?	Strong Password?	Recovery Email Configured?
Google	Yes	Yes	Yes
GitHub	Yes	Yes	Yes
LinkedIn	No	Yes	Yes

Part D: Cyber Threat Research

Research and explain the following threats:

1. Phishing

Definition:

Phishing is a cyberattack where scammers pretend to be a trusted person or company to trick people into revealing passwords, bank details, or other sensitive information.

Real-world Example:

A fake email claiming to be from a bank asks you to click a link and enter your login credentials. The link leads to a fraudulent website that steals your information.

Prevention Methods:

- Check the sender's email address carefully.
- Avoid clicking suspicious links or attachments.
- Verify requests through official websites or contacts.
- Enable two-factor authentication (2FA).
- Keep security software updated.

2. Malware

Definition:

Malware is malicious software designed to harm, disrupt, or gain unauthorized access to computers, networks, or devices. It includes viruses, worms, trojans, spyware, and other harmful programs.

Real world example :

A user downloads a free program from an untrusted website. The software contains malware that secretly steals personal information from the computer.

Prevention Methods:

- Install and update antivirus software regularly.
- Download software only from trusted sources.

- Keep operating systems and applications updated.
- Avoid opening suspicious email attachments.
- Scan USB drives before using them.

3. Ransomware

Definition:

Ransomware is a type of malware that encrypts a user's files and demands a payment in exchange for restoring access to them.

Real World Example:

In 2017, the WannaCry ransomware attack affected hundreds of thousands of computers worldwide, disrupting hospitals, businesses, and government organizations by locking their files and demanding ransom payments.

Prevention Methods:

- Regularly back up important data.
- Keep software and systems updated.
- Use reliable antivirus and security software.
- Avoid downloading files from unknown sources.
- Be cautious when opening email attachments and links.

4. Social Engineering

Definition:

Social engineering is a technique used by attackers to manipulate people into revealing confidential information or performing actions that compromise security.

Real Worlds Example:

An attacker calls an employee while pretending to be an IT support technician and convinces them to share their login credentials to "fix" a problem.

Prevention Methods:

- Verify the identity of anyone requesting sensitive information.
- Never share passwords with others.
- Be cautious of urgent or unexpected requests.
- Attend cybersecurity awareness training.
- Report suspicious messages or calls.

5. Data Breach

Definition:

A data breach occurs when sensitive or confidential information is accessed, stolen, or exposed without authorization.

Real World Example:

In 2017, the credit reporting company Equifax experienced a major data breach that exposed the personal information of millions of people, including names, addresses, and Social Security numbers.

Prevention Methods:

- Use strong and unique passwords.
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- Encrypt sensitive data.
- Regularly update software and security systems.
- Limit access to confidential information and monitor systems for suspicious activity.

Part E: Cyber Security Awareness Poster

Part F: Security Reflection

Answer the following:

1. What cybersecurity risks did you identify in your own digital habits?

After reviewing my digital habits, I identified several cybersecurity risks. One risk was using simple and easy-to-remember passwords for some accounts. Another risk was using the same password for multiple websites, which could make several accounts vulnerable if one password was compromised.

I also noticed that I sometimes connect to public Wi-Fi networks without checking their security. In addition, I occasionally click on links or download files without fully verifying their source. Keeping software and applications updated is another area that I need to pay more attention to.

Recognizing these risks has helped me understand the importance of following good cybersecurity practices, such as using strong unique passwords, enabling Multi-Factor Authentication, avoiding suspicious links, and regularly updating devices and applications.

2. What security improvements will you implement immediately?

To improve my cybersecurity, I will start using strong and unique passwords for all my accounts. I will also enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) wherever it is available to add an extra layer of security.

I will make sure to keep my devices, apps, and software updated so that security vulnerabilities are fixed promptly. I will be more careful when opening emails, clicking links, or downloading files, especially from unknown sources. In addition, I will avoid using unsecured public Wi-Fi networks for sensitive activities and regularly back up important data.

These improvements will help protect my personal information and reduce the risk of cyberattacks.

3. Why is cybersecurity important in today's world?

Cybersecurity is important in today's world because people rely heavily on the internet and digital technology for communication, education, banking, shopping, and work. As more personal and financial information is stored online, the risk of cyberattacks and data theft also increases.

Cybersecurity helps protect sensitive information from hackers, malware, and other online threats. It prevents unauthorized access to devices, accounts, and networks, reducing the chances of financial loss, identity theft, and privacy violations.

For businesses and organizations, cybersecurity is essential for protecting customer data, maintaining trust, and ensuring that services continue to operate smoothly. In today's digital age, strong cybersecurity practices are necessary to keep individuals, businesses, and society safe from cyber threats.